



MANDAR DEODHAR

DELHI | Stoking the Flames

The Indo-Pak diplomatic see-saw continues even as justice eludes the victims of the 26/11 Mumbai attacks more than four months on. After delaying action against the perpetrators on flimsy grounds, Islamabad has bought more time saying that the information provided by Delhi is "inadequate". On April 11, Pakistan communicated to India that the 400-page dossier on the attacks fell short of their requirement. In a sharp response, Delhi has dubbed this as a ploy to delay the investigation. India had provided exhaustive answers to the 30 questions that Pakistan posed, hoping it would expedite the investigations. India says that this is not the first time Islamabad has resorted to diversionary tactics. Despite public assurances to Indian leaders that it will not allow its soil to be used for terror activities, Pakistan has repeatedly reneged on its pledge. India has suspended bilateral talks with Pakistan in the wake of the Mumbai attacks. Pakistan too has suffered collateral damage in recent times with suicide bombings and attacks on government facilities. Intelligence reports have warned of fresh attacks in India originating from Pakistan in the run-up to the general elections, which may increase tensions between the neighbours. While Pakistan's response may escalate the tensions between the two, its latest gambit raises a big question of whether India's coercive diplomacy is actually working on Pakistan. This will be the key concern that the new government in Delhi would have to tackle.

by Saurabh Shukla

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questions posed by Pakistan have been answered by India, but Islamabad still finds the replies "inadequate".

THE TAJ MAHAL
HOTEL DURING
THE 26/11
ATTACK